

STATS AND FACTS

The Australian *Dromornis* was once hailed as the largest bird to have ever lived. However, it recently lost the top spot after the discovery of *Vorombe*, a giant prehistoric bird from Madagascar.

Dromornis males weighed about 1,287 lb (584 kg).

Vorombe had an average weight of 1,433 lb (650 kg).

At 344 lb (156 kg), the ostrich is the heaviest bird alive today.



Family values

Dromornis is thought to have had only a few chicks at a time, each of which grew slowly. Although *Dromornis* mothers nurtured the eggs before hatching, it is likely that both parents looked after the young. This bird aggressively defended its nests and, based on the behavior of its living relatives, paleontologists think that *Dromornis* parents might have formed long-lasting pairs.